



Scoring a point: Just as NBA teams don't lose games 108-115 or La Liga teams lose contests 2-4, tennis players at every level don't lose matches 4-6, 5-7. The proper score — whether written or spoken — is 6-4, 7-5.

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compared to about 40% in soccer, basketball, ice hockey, and football. Rightly annoyed by lackadaisical, dawdling players, McEnroe lauded



the adoption of a 25-second 'serve clock' and escalating penalties for violations. "I am so happy that the US Open is employing the shot clock on court in the main draw," P-Mac said. "This is great for the fans. We have to keep things moving, change with the times."

As one of the world's most popular sports, tennis has plenty to brag about. But it should adopt and enforce rules — both written and unwritten—that promote fairness for players and entertainment for fans.

Towards this end, I've listed some pet peeves about what tennis can and should do without.

The wacko warmup — One of Australian pro Daria Saville's pet peeves is opponents hitting winners during the pre-match warmup. I can't conceive of that on the pro tour. At Forest Park in Springfield, Massachusetts, where I practice, a colourful character used to whack

Ground reality: The primary responsibility of ball boys and girls is to efficiently remove balls from the playing area and then quickly return to their stationary positions. GETTY IMAGES

winners during the warmup, and when it was over, he'd crow, "I won the warmup!" At a senior tournament warmup, my opponent kept blasting balls in the corners. To add insult to injury, when I hit a weak return, he'd hit a drop shot.

Ball kids older than 14 years of age — Towering, older teenagers, and even young adults with beards, perform this important but routine job when much younger ball kids can do it just as well. The primary responsibility of ball boys and girls is to efficiently remove balls from the playing area and then quickly return to their stationary positions. However, I believe a secondary goal should be to inspire and educate young players from 10 to 14, the formative ages, about the many facets of tournament tennis they witness up close.

Backward scores — Want to know the score of the only Grand Slam match Novak Djokovic lost this year? Go to his 'Player Activity' section on the ATP website. There you will find the score for the Wimbledon final that he lost to

We should look at how 24-time major winner, Novak Djokovic, graciously handles defeat, no matter how big the upset or how prestigious the tournament.